

Sarvesh Kushare

Sarvesh Kushare has built one of India's strongest gold cases through record-breaking height and remarkable consistency this season. His 2.31m clearance at the National Inter-State Championships made him the first Indian to clear 2.30m and placed him among the world's leading jumpers in 2026. He then finished third at the Monaco Diamond League with 2.26m and took Commonwealth Games silver at 2.25m. South Korea's Woo Sang-hyeok remains the most accomplished rival, with a 2.36m best, but his August form dipped to 2.16m in Silesia and 2.14m in Heilbronn. Japan has selected Ryoichi Akamatsu, a 2.30m performer, and Hirokazu Sakai, who has cleared 2.25m this year. China has no men's high jumper in its published team. Kushare must still negotiate a field rich in experience, but repeated clearances beyond 2.25m make him a genuine gold favourite. His reliable first-attempt efficiency could decide a close countback.

MEN'S
HIGH JUMP

